

Yuan Xiao (Joel)

236-967-4988

Game & Visual Designer

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Blending creativity with technology, I specialize in crafting intuitive UIs and immersive 3D environments that enhance user experience. With a meticulous eye for detail and a user-centered approach, I strive to create visually compelling and highly engaging digital experiences.

<https://onesoilY.github.io/yuan/>

SKILLS

Development & Programming

JavaScript

React

HTML & CSS

Unity

Visual Design

After Effects

Illustrator

Photoshop

Figma

Maya

EDUCATION

Simon Fraser University
Bachelor of Science in Interactive Arts & Technology | Cumulative GPA: 3.47

09/2021 – present

PROJECT EXPERIENCES

VR Developer & 3D Modeler, *Beyond the Horizon* – VR Game

01/2025 – 04/2025

- Focused on front-end and visual design, developed interactive UI and environments in Unity to ensure an intuitive and immersive player experience from the start.
- Created high-fidelity 3D environments and assets, independently modeled and textured key elements such as the bedroom, photographs, swim tube, and mirror, enhancing narrative depth and atmospheric storytelling.
- Implemented core interactions and functionality, wrote C# scripts to handle VR physics-based collision detection, object interactions, and memory-triggering mechanics, continuously optimizing performance for a seamless experience.
- Enhanced player immersion, coordinated lighting, sound design, and cinematic transitions to create a smooth emotional progression from despair to healing and hope.

3D Modeler and Animator, *Set Sail Again* – Short Film

09/2024 – 12/2024

- Led the 3D modeling process and utilized Maya to create optimized topology, clean mesh structures, and perform texture and weight painting for both characters and environments, ensuring smooth animation and rendering.
- Applied keyframing and physics-based motion simulations to refine character movement and environmental interactions, strengthening visual storytelling.
- Used Arnold for realistic lighting setup and material adjustments, followed by color correction and editing in Premiere Pro for a cohesive visual style.
- Iteratively tested shot compositions, scene layouts, and character animations to maintain narrative coherence and technical precision.

Web Developer, SFU Climate Community Interactive Website

02/2024 – 04/2024

- Built a multi-page responsive website using semantic HTML structure and advanced CSS techniques such as media queries and animations.
- Carefully designed typography and color contrast to ensure a consistent and user-friendly experience across different devices and browsers.
- Iterative user testing and refinement, regularly gathered user feedback, adjusted page layouts, and optimized visual hierarchy to improve usability and interaction.
- Designed content and structure in alignment with community outreach goals, ensuring the website effectively conveyed climate-related messages.

2D Animator, Kinetic Typography for Avril Lavigne's "I'm with You"

07/2023 – 08/2023

- Designed and developed a kinetic typography animation for Avril Lavigne's song I'm with You, utilizing Adobe After Effects to create smooth transitions and engaging visual effects.
- Applied sequential design principles to ensure fluid motion and consistency throughout the video.
- Integrated digital photography and vector image elements to enhance the visual composition and storytelling.